💙 Postpartum Depression

Understanding the "baby blues" vs. PPD — you are not alone, and effective help is available

🔍 TYPES OF POSTPARTUM MOOD DISORDERS

😊 Baby Blues (very common — 70–80%)
Mild mood swings, tearfulness, anxiety, irritability starting 2–3 days after delivery. Resolves on its own within **2 weeks**. Does NOT require medication.

😔 Postpartum Depression (10–15% of mothers)
More intense, lasts beyond 2 weeks. Begins anytime in the **first year** after birth. Requires evaluation and treatment.

⚡ Postpartum Psychosis (rare — 1 in 1000)
Hallucinations, delusions, confusion. **Medical emergency — call 911 or go to ER immediately.**

🚨 PPD SYMPTOMS — WHAT TO WATCH FOR

- 😢 Persistent sadness, emptiness, hopelessness beyond 2 weeks
- 😤 Excessive irritability, anger, or rage
- 😴 Exhaustion beyond normal new-parent tiredness
- 😰 Intense anxiety, panic attacks, intrusive thoughts
- 💔 Difficulty bonding with or feeling disconnected from your baby
- 🍽️ Changes in appetite — eating much more or much less
- 🤔 Trouble concentrating, making decisions, or thinking clearly
- 🚶 Withdrawing from family and friends
- ⚫ Loss of interest in things you used to enjoy

🚨 **Thoughts of harming yourself or your baby = Emergency. Call 988 or 911 immediately.**

💊 TREATMENT — YOU HAVE OPTIONS

Medical Treatment

- ⭐ FDA-Approved **Brexanolone (Zulresso)** — IV infusion, first PPD-specific treatment. Rapid effect.
- ⭐ FDA-Approved **Zuranolone (Zurzuvae)** — oral pill, 14-day course. New PPD treatment.
- SSRIs Sertraline (Zoloft), escitalopram — most commonly used; compatible with breastfeeding
- SNRIs Venlafaxine — alternative if SSRIs not effective

Therapy & Support

- 🧠 Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT) — highly effective
- 👥 Postpartum support groups — connection with other mothers
- 🏠 Partner and family support — practical help at home
- 😴 Sleep prioritization — even 4–5 hour stretches help

⭐ RISK FACTORS & PREVENTION

You May Be at Higher Risk If:

- 📋 Personal history of depression or anxiety
- 💊 History of PMDD or postpartum depression before
- 🏠 Limited social support or relationship difficulties
- 👶 Infant health problems, NICU stay, or difficult delivery
- 💰 Financial stress, recent major life changes
- 🤱 Difficulty or decision conflict about breastfeeding

Prevention Steps

- 💬 Talk openly with your provider — screen early and often
- 🍱 Meal prep, accept help, prioritize rest
- 📱 Postpartum Support International: **postpartum.net**
- ☎️ PSI HelpLine: **1-800-944-4773**

💙 Asking for Help Is a Sign of Strength — Not Weakness

PPD affects 1 in 7 mothers — you are not alone. Seeking treatment doesn't mean you're a bad mother. It means you're doing everything you can to be well for yourself and your baby. Recovery is real and possible. Please reach out to our office anytime — we are here for you. 💙 — (281) 557-0300